

PERSONAL LEADERSHIP SERIES

The Wheel and the Arrow

A teaching guide to personal leadership and goal setting

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Leadership begins with leading yourself

Most leadership is about leading others. Personal leadership is the quiet, daily work of leading yourself – at work, at home, among others, and when no one is watching.

BEING
who you are today

→

BECOMING
who you are growing into

I am sure of this: he who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus. **Philippians 1:6**

DEFINING SUCCESS

What does success actually mean?

> *“Success is the progressive realisation of worthwhile, predetermined personal goals.”*
>
> — Paul J. Meyer

Progressive

Not a finish line but a direction – you are succeeding while you move.

Predetermined

It seldom happens by accident; it grows from decisions made ahead of time.

Personal

It comes from your own convictions, not from others' expectations.

DEFINING SUCCESS

Measured against your own potential

The comparison trap
There is always someone further ahead – the comparison never ends.

The only true measure
Who you are now compared with who you could become.

1 Unmeasurable
Unexpected challenges draw out strengths we did not know we had.

2 Largely unused
Most of us have gifts we have never really developed.

3 Developed on purpose
The reserve opens through deliberate effort.

Each one should test his own work. Then he can take pride in himself alone, and not in comparison with someone else. For each one will carry his own load. **Galatians 6:4–5**

PART ONE

The inner foundation

Before you plan outward, look at the ground you stand on – your enthusiasm and your self-image.

Do not let yourselves be pressed into the mould of this age, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind, so that you can test and discern what the will of God is – what is good, pleasing and perfect. Romans 12:2

THE INNER FOUNDATION

What wears down our enthusiasm

Children are curious, flexible and unafraid of failing. Three things wear that away.

The weight of daily duties

The busier we are, the shorter our view.

The pull to fit in

The more we bend to be accepted, the more our creativity fades.

A learned fear of failure

Harshly treated mistakes teach us to play it safe.

Part of personal leadership is to recover the openness and hope you once had as a child.

THE INNER FOUNDATION

A healthier self-image

We tend to live in line with the person we believe we are.

See that you are unique

There is no one you need to measure yourself against.

Accept yourself honestly

Name strengths and weaknesses plainly, as facts.

Speak true words to yourself

Believable statements push back old doubts.

Reach small goals

Each success shows what you are capable of.

And make peace with mistakes – they are steps to build on, not stones to trip over.

THE WHEEL OF LIFE

Six areas of one life

Trouble at home follows us to work; worry at work sits down with us at the dinner table.

Ethics & Values
Your convictions, your spiritual life and the principles you live by.

Mind & Learning
How you grow in knowledge, understanding and skill.

Society & Community
Friendships, service and your place among other people.

Body & Health
Energy, fitness, food and rest.

Family & Home
Your spouse, your children and the home you share.

Work & Finances
Your calling at work, how you do it, and how you handle money.

And Jesus kept growing in wisdom and in stature, and in favour with God and with people. **Luke 2:52**

THE WHEEL OF LIFE

Score your wheel – an honest snapshot

1 Score each area 1–10

1 at the centre = not satisfied at all; 10 at the rim = completely satisfied.

2 Mark each spoke

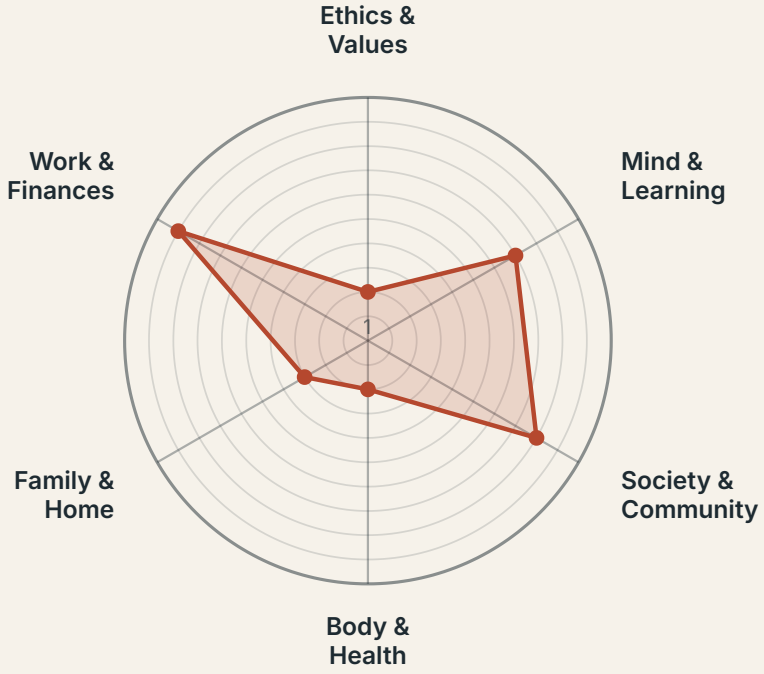
Measured against the standard you have set for yourself.

3 Join the marks

The outline is the shape of your wheel today.

A wheel with a 9 for work and a 2 for health gives a bumpy ride. Let it grow outward – and stay round.

What an unbalanced wheel looks like



A life can race ahead in one area while another nearly stalls – and the ride is rough.

Ethics & Values	2/10
Mind & Learning	7/10
Society & Community	8/10
Body & Health	2/10
Family & Home	3/10
Work & Finances	9/10

Grow every spoke – balance beats a single high score.

PART TWO

The Arrow – setting goals

The wheel shows where you stand. The arrow is how you move – an intention turned into a dated, trackable plan.

Brothers and sisters, I do not consider that I have already taken hold of it. But one thing I do: forgetting what lies behind and stretching out toward what lies ahead, I press on toward the mark, for the prize of God's upward call in Christ Jesus. Philippians 3:13–14

THE MECHANISM OF GOAL SETTING

Why write it down?

✕ The famous "3% Yale study" never took place.

Gail Matthews (Dominican University, 2007): 149 adults, five groups, four weeks – average progress per group.



Write it down · commit to steps · be accountable to someone.

THE MECHANISM OF GOAL SETTING

Shape every goal to be SMART

S	**Specific**	Not "save money" but "I am building an emergency fund."
M	**Measurable**	Numbers or milestones you can track.
A	**Attainable**	It stretches you but stays realistic.
R	**Relevant & Realistic**	It fits your values and this season of life.
T	**Time-bound**	A goal without a date is a wish.

THE GOAL PLANNING WORKSHEET

The worksheet, section by section

The goal
A SMART sentence in the positive present tense

Why it matters
What you gain – and what you avoid

Obstacles & plans
Name the resistance; plan each detour

Action steps
Small steps, each with a date

Who should know
People who support you and ask

Track progress
When and how you check

Worth it?
Values and cost – a last check

Reminders & pictures
Cues that keep the goal in view

A COMPLETED EXAMPLE

A finished worksheet: Work & Finances

The goal

"I am saving 1,500 USD in a dedicated emergency fund by automating a 500 USD transfer on the 1st of October, November and December."

What I gain

Peace of mind, less stress in my marriage, and protection for my family against unexpected costs without relying on credit cards.

What I avoid

The anxiety of living from pay cheque to pay cheque, the pain of high-interest debt, and arguments about money at home.

Impulse spending at the weekend.

→ A fixed cash-only budget for weekends; the cards stay at home.

Forgetting to make the transfer.

→ An automatic recurring transfer on payday in the banking app.

TAKING THE FIRST STEPS

Your turn: one goal for each area

Not dozens of goals – one meaningful goal per area, in the positive present tense, anchored in your reason why.

- **Ethics & Values**
- **Mind & Learning**
- **Society & Community**
- **Body & Health**
- **Family & Home**
- **Work & Finances**

Commit your works to the LORD, and your plans will stand firm. **Proverbs 16:3**

The life you live tomorrow

is shaped by the decisions and actions you commit to paper today.

TAKE THE WHEEL. AIM THE ARROW.